Level 6 EPA: Advanced Programmes

Advanced Data Fellowship (ADF starts after Sept 2023), Advanced Software Engineering (ASWE), and Technology Consulting (TC)

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What is the EPA?

End Point Assessment (EPA) is an impartial assessment of whether you have developed the knowledge, skills, and behaviours (KSBs) outlined in the apprenticeship standard. There are core (all apprentices complete) KSBs and option/pathway KSBs as below:

- ADF apprentices are on the Data Analyst pathway.
- ASWE apprentices are on the Software Engineering pathway.
- TC apprentices are on the IT Consultant pathway.

The assessor will be testing your occupational competence and how you've applied the KSBs in your role.

The EPA is the final component of your degree and is worth 30 credits (15% of your overall degree classification). Your EPA must be passed in order to achieve your degree.

Who delivers the EPA?

EPAs are delivered by Multiverse and are wholly independent. This means the assessor reviewing your evidence and delivering your assessment hasn't played any part in your apprenticeship journey.

Your assessor will be fully trained in assessment delivery and an industry expert. The assessor will be a different person to the coaches and instructors you would've met during your programme.

What are the assessments and how are they assessed at EPA?

There are two assessment methods (AM) which focus on the application of the KSBs in different ways. Each AM is weighted equally.

AM1: Project report with presentation, questions, and answers

We call this the **Capstone Project** on your programme and is part of your final module.

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The project is completed at any point during your programme. The write up of your project report cannot commence until you have gatewayed. You can also continue to work on your project after gateway. You will have 60 working days to write your report and create a presentation. You will need to submit the following:

- 6,000 word project report (plus or minus 10% is acceptable).
    - Appendices, references, and diagrams are not included in this total.
- Presentation slides, speaker notes, and supporting materials e.g., prompt cards, reference documents.

Your presentation and questioning will last for 60-minutes, typically split 30-minutes for the presentation and 30-minutes for questions and answers.

AM2: Professional discussion underpinned by a portfolio.

Your portfolio is a collection of project submissions from all your modules that you will have already completed. You can refine your portfolio at any point during your programme. This work will have already contributed to your degree grade, but will now inform your EPA grade via your professional discussion. Your portfolio is not graded as it is used to underpin your professional discussion, which is graded. There is no word count for your portfolio.

The professional discussion is a 60-minute discussion against the KSBs for AM2. The portfolio will be used to support questions and answers. It also gives the assessor an opportunity to assess you holistically.

How do I pick a suitable capstone project (AM1)?

A capstone project, or work-based project, involves you completing a significant and defined piece of work that has a real business application and benefit. The project must meet the needs of your employer and be relevant to your occupation and apprenticeship.

Your project can be based on a specific problem, a recurring issue, or an idea or opportunity. The topic of your project is entirely up to you.

You can work as part of a team to complete the project which could include technical internal or external support. However, the project report must be your own work and reflective of your own role and contribution. Your report should cover the following areas which ensures your project gives you scope to work on an entire project end-to-end:

- An introduction to your project.
- The scope of the project (including key performance indicators and stakeholder engagement).
- How the outcomes would be achieved.

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- A project plan.
- Research and findings.
- Project outcomes.
- Recommendations and conclusions.

How much time should I spend writing my project report (AM1)?

There's no definitive answer. You have 60 working days to write up your report and your presentation. You and your manager will need to decide how much time to commit to this.

As a minimum we recommend at least a couple days a week. It's important you check how far along you are every week so you keep on track to your submission deadline.

If you're concerned about the deadlines within the EPA period it's important you flag this as early as possible. Please ensure you contact your coach (or other named Multiverse contact) who can offer the right support at the right time.

How will I be graded?

You'll have heard all about KSBs on your programme. These are what you'll be assessed and graded against at EPA. Each KSB has an associated grading criteria (Appendix A) which the assessor will use to come to their grading decision.

For each AM you will be awarded a Fail, Pass, or Distinction. These grades will be combined to give you an overall EPA grade as set out in the table below. **Note:** These grades are defined and outlined in the apprenticeship standard.

AM1: Project report with presentation, questions, and answers	**AM2:** Professional discussion underpinned by a portfolio	**Overall Grade**
Fail	Any grade	**Fail**
Any grade	Fail	**Fail**
Pass	Pass	**Pass**
Pass	Distinction	**Merit**
Distinction	Pass	**Merit**
Distinction	Distinction	**Distinction**

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What happens if I fail my EPA?

If you fail one or both assessment methods you will have the opportunity to resit or retake them. A resit is typically taken within 3-months of your EPA results. A retake requires extra training so is typically taken within 6-months of your EPA results. Your coach will work with you to agree on a suitable time frame.

Where a resit or retake is required your EPA grade will be capped at a Merit (unless Multiverse determines there are extenuating circumstances (EC) through an accepted EC claim).

When does my EPA begin?

When you're approaching EPA and feel you're ready you will enter Gateway. This is the final check between you, your employer, and Multiverse that you're ready to complete EPA (and your programme).

You must meet the following Gateway requirements before starting EPA:

- Confirm you are ready to take the EPA.
- Achieved English and mathematics qualifications or functional skills.
- Completed and passed all required elements of your degree, except the EPA (your final module).
- Submit a project title and summary for your capstone project (AM1).
- Submit your completed portfolio (AM2).

You will complete your Gateway submission with your coach at the end of your programme during your final module, the capstone project.

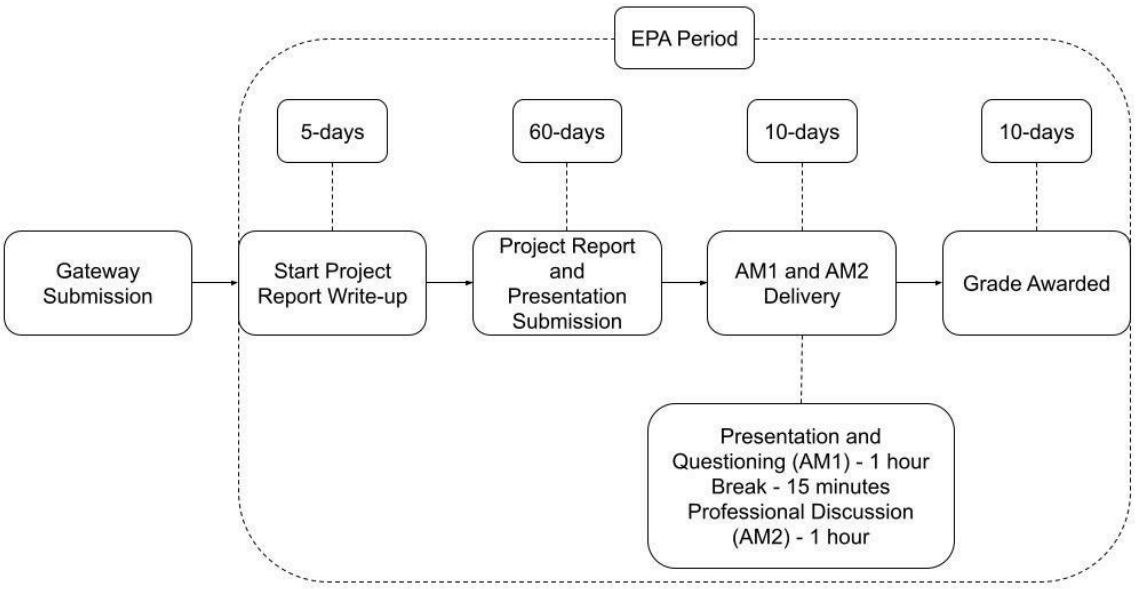
What is the typical timeline?

Your EPA will be calculated from your Gateway date. This will be booked with your coach at some point during Year 3. The final 3 months of your programme and your EPA will typically be structured as follows:

When*	What	Why
Approx. 3-months before Gateway	Work on capstone project and prepare for EPA	This is the project you will be writing up for EPA. It can start at any point during your programme. Most of this time will be focussed on your project, doing the work, and developing your evidence plus any additional EPA prep. The capstone project can still be worked on after Gateway.
Gateway date (Confirmed	Submitting evidence relating to minimum	Ensuring that you, your employer, and Multiverse believe you are ready for EPA. This evidence will be reviewed and your

When*	What	Why
between coach and apprentice)	Gateway requirements.	Gateway approved or rejected. If rejected, you will be notified what additional evidence is required.
5 working days after Gateway submission	EPA period begins and project write up starts	This is your time to write up your report, collate your evidence, and create your presentation. You can still work on your project if it's not complete.
60 working days after Gateway approval	Submitting your project report and presentation materials	Your written report and project presentation materials are checked for plagiarism and AI use. The assessor will start formulating their question bank.
10 working days after submission	Deliver your presentation (AM1) and professional discussion (AM2)	60-minute presentation and questioning followed by a 60-minute professional discussion. There will be a short break in between.
10 working days after EPA delivery	Grade awarded	Individual AM grades and an overall EPA grade are shared with you. Written feedback is supplied to explain the grading decision. This is your apprenticeship grade.

The EPA period is shown below. Days mentioned are working days (Monday to Friday). Bank Holiday's do not count as a working day.



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***All working days mentioned are for guidance only. These may change as you get closer to your EPA. Your coach will be able to confirm the exact dates when you're nearing your Gateway meeting.**

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Appendix A: Grading Criteria

AM1

To achieve a Pass you must meet all Pass criteria. To achieve a Distinction you must meet all Pass and Distinction criteria.

Core (All apprentices)		
Theme and KSBS	**Pass**	**Distinction**
The Organisational Context K1 K2	Identifies the role digital technology solutions play in gaining a competitive advantage by adapting and exploiting them (K1) Explains the principles of strategic decision making concerning the acquisition or development of digital and technology solutions. (K2)	
Project Requirements S3 B3	Analyses relevant evidence to produce a proposal for a digital and technology based project in line with legal, ethical and regulatory requirements whilst ensuring the protection of personal data, safety and security (S3,B3)	
Project Planning and Resources K3 K4 K15 S2 S14	Produces a project plan which estimates risks and opportunities and determines mitigation strategies.' (K3,	

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	S2) Evaluates appropriate techniques and approaches that are used in creating a business case (K4) The project applies techniques to estimate cost and time resource constraints.' (K15) Researches information on innovative technologies/approaches and investigates and evaluates them in the development of a digital and technology solution. (S14)	
Solution Proposal S1	Analyses the business problem behind the project proposal to identify the role of digital and technology solutions. (S1)	Justifies their choice of digital and technology solutions for specific roles in the project proposal. (S1)
Project Delivery K5 S5 S6	Carries out the identified solution proposal utilising a range of digital tools and standard approaches. (K5, S5) Manages the project delivery to achieve digital and technology solutions. (S6)	Justifies the selection and use of standard processes and methods. (K5, S5)
Project Evaluation K17 K18 S13	Justifies their methods of research and	Compares and contrasts their chosen

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	evaluation which determined the selection of digital and technology solutions identified for the project. (K18) Presents an overview of the project to appropriate stakeholders using appropriate language and style. (K17, S13, B5)	digital technology solution to alternative approaches within their research outcomes. (K18,S13)
Software Engineer (SWE apprentices only)		
Technical Solutions K25 K26 K27	Analyses the factors affecting product quality and the approaches controlling them throughout the project development process. (K25/SEK5). Selects and applies software tools appropriate to the Software Engineering project solution. (K26/SEK6) Outlines approaches to the interpretation and use of artefacts. (K27/SEK7)	Evaluates the impact of approaches used to control product quality throughout the project development process. (K25/SEK5)
Innovation and Response S16 S17 S18 S19 S22	Identifies and defines a non-routine, unspecified software engineering problem. (S16/SES1)	Evaluates their choice of software engineering solution for the project brief. (S17/SES2)

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	Recommends a software engineering solution that is appropriate for the project brief. (S17/SES2) Selects and applies analysis methods, approaches and techniques in software engineering projects to deliver an outcome that meets requirements. (S18/SES3) Demonstrates how they implement software engineering projects using appropriate software engineering methods, approaches and techniques. (S19/SES4) Evaluates their selection of approach, methodology, analysis and outcomes to identify both lessons learned and recommendations for improvements to future projects software engineering projects. (S22/SES7)	Justifies their choice of analysis methods approaches and techniques. (S18/SE3) Compares and contrasts the implementation of their software engineering solution with alternative approaches. (S22/SES7)
IT Consultant (TC apprentices only)		
Underlying Principles K29 K32	Evaluates the principles of different consulting methodologies. (K29/ITK1) Summarises the barriers to solving problems or maximizing opportunities.	

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	(K32/ITK4)	
Innovation and Response K33 S24 S26 S28	Analyses client needs to advise a strategic approach to improve business processes, provide new ideas and/or technology solutions. (S24/ITS1) Demonstrates presenting recommendations to stakeholders and influencing action, considering risks, costs and benefits. (K33/ITK5, S26/ITS3) Demonstrates how they perform stakeholder analysis to identify, determine and deepen understanding of system requirements and develop client relationships. (S28, ITS5)	Critically evaluates the impact of methods used to present recommendations to stakeholders. (K33/ITK5, S26/ITS3)
Ethics and Landscape S30	Evaluates how they ensure legal and ethical requirements are accommodated in the development of digital and technology solutions. (S30/ITS7)	
Technical Solutions S31	Demonstrates how they evaluate the success of a new system, process, or initiative. (S31, ITS8)	
Data Analyst (ADF apprentices only)		

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Underlying Principles K54 K56 K58	Critically analyses data sets, using a range of industry standard tools and data analysis methods. (K54/DAK2) Outlines sources of data used for the project. (K56/DAK4) Describes how Data Analytics operates within the context of data governance, data security, and communications in respect of the project. (K58/DAK6)	Summarises the outcomes of analysing, interpreting and evaluating complex information from diverse datasets. (K54/DAK2) Critically evaluates sources of data for the project. (K56/DAK4)
Innovation and Response S50 S52 S53 S54 S55	Visualises data to tell compelling and actionable narratives by using the best medium for each audience. (S50/DAS3) Demonstrates how they have applied a range of techniques for analysing quantitative data such as data mining, time series forecasting, algorithms, statistics and modelling techniques to identify and predict trends and patterns in data. (S52/DAS5) Demonstrates how they have applied exploratory or confirmatory approaches to analysing data. and how they have validated and tested stability of the results. (S53/DAS6)	Evaluates their approach to finding, presenting, communicating and disseminating data analysis outputs effectively and with high impact through creative storytelling, tailoring the message for the audience. Compares and contrasts alternative approaches to visualise data to tell compelling and actionable narratives by using the best medium for each audience. (S50/DAS3) Evaluates how they apply a wide range of techniques for analysing quantitative data such as data mining, time series forecasting, algorithms, statistics and modelling techniques to identify and predict trends and

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	Demonstrates how they extract data from a range of sources. (S54/DAS7) Demonstrates how they analyse, in detail large data sets, using appropriate industry standard tools and data analysis methods. (S55/DAS8)	patterns in data. (S52/DAS5) Evaluates how they apply exploratory or confirmatory approaches to analysing data and evaluates their approach to in depth validation and testing stability of the results. (S53/DAS6) Evaluates their approach to in depth extraction of data from a range of sources leading making conclusions from the data for decision-making purposes for an internal or external stakeholder.(S54/DAS7) Evaluates their approach to analysing in detail large data sets, using a range of industry standard tools and data analysis methods and suggests how this allows internal or external stakeholders to draw conclusions from the data for decision-making purposes. (S55/DAS8)

AM2

To achieve a Pass you must meet all Pass criteria. To achieve a Distinction you must meet all Pass and Distinction criteria.

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Core (All apprentices)		
Theme and KSBS	**Pass**	**Distinction**
The Organisational Context K7	Reviews the roles, functions and activities relevant to technology solutions within an organisation. (K7)	
Core Technical Concepts K6 K11 K12 K14 K16	Critically evaluates the nature and scope of common vulnerabilities in digital and technology solutions (K11) Explains core technical concepts for digital and technology solutions, including: - The approaches and techniques used throughout the digital and technology solution lifecycle and their applicability to an organisation's standards and pre-existing tools.(K6) - Data gathering, data management, and data analysis.(K12, K14) - Computer networking concepts.(K16)	
Applied Technical Solutions K13 S4 S9 S10 S11 S12	Demonstrates the use of core technical concepts for digital and technology solutions, including:	

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	- Initiate, design, code, test and debug a software component for a digital and technology solution. (S4) - Security and resilience techniques. (S9) - Initiates, designs, implements and debugs a data product for a digital and technology solution. (S10) - Plans, designs and manages simple computer networks. (S12) - Applies the principles of data analysis for digital and technology solutions. (K13, S11)	
Leading and Working Together K8 K9 K10 S7 S8 B4 B6 B7	Explains how teams work effectively to produce a digital and technology solution applying relevant organisational theories using up to date awareness of trends and innovations. (K8, S7, B4,B6,B7) Describes the concepts and principles of leadership and management as they relate to their roleand how they apply them. (K9, K10,S8)	

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Social Infrastructure - Legal, Ethical and Sustainability K19 K20 S15 B1 B2 B8	Applies relevant legal, ethical, social and professional standards to digital and technology solutions considering both technical and non-technical audiences and in line with organisational guidelines. (K19, S15, B1, B2, B5) Explains sustainable development approaches within digital technologies as they relate to their role including diversity and inclusion. (K20, B8)	Justifies the application of relevant legal, ethical, social and professional standards to digital and technology solutions. (K19, S15) Evaluates the impact of sustainable digital technology practices of their organisation. (K20)
Software Engineer (SWE apprentices only)		
Underlying Principles K21 K22 K23	Describes scenarios covering all stages of a development lifecycle, identifying techniques and methods are applied in each case. (K21/SEK1) Explains the principles of a range of development techniques, for each stage of the software development cycle that produce artefacts and the contexts in which they can be applied. (K22/SEK2) Explains the principles of a range of development methods and approaches and the contexts in which they can be	

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	applied. (K23/ SEK3)	
Technical Solutions K24 K28	Describes. how to interpret and implement a design, compliant with functional, non-functional and security requirements. K24/SEK4 Describes how tools that support teamwork can be used effectively. K28/SEK8	
Innovation and Response S20 S21	Describes how they respond to changing priorities and problems arising within software engineering projects by making revised recommendations, and adapting plans as necessary, to fit the scenario being investigated. (S20/SES5) Explains how they determine, refine, adapt and use appropriate software engineering methods, approaches and techniques to evaluate software engineering project outcomes. (S21/SES6)	Demonstrates how their actions have influenced the creation of appropriate plans within teams and contributed to project outcomes. (S20/SES5) Compares and contrasts how they respond to changing priorities and problems arising within software engineering projects by making revised recommendations, and adapting plans as necessary, to fit the scenario being investigated. (S20/SES5)
Legal, Ethics and Landscape S23	Describes how they extend and update software development knowledge with evidence from professional and academic sources by undertaking	

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	appropriate research to inform best practice and lead improvements in the organisation. (S23/SES8)	
IT Consultant (TC apprentices only)		
Underlying Principles K30 K31 K34 K35 K36	Explains how consulting interfaces with project management, business analysis and business management. (K30/ITK2) Explains the principles of change management within organisations. (K31/ITK3) Compares and contrasts approaches to analytical and critical thinking to define business problems objectively and create value for the client. (K32/ITK6) Describes questioning strategies and active listening to ensure all requirements are gathered. (K35/ITK7) Explains the ethical and legal requirements in client/provider relationships. (K36/ITK8)	
Innovation and Response S25 S27	Evaluates how they effectively communicate value add to the client	Compares and contrasts how they effectively communicate value add to

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	through a variety of media in a professional setting through performing socio-technical process improvements in a range of environments. (S25/ITS2) Explain how they participate in walk-throughs for IT, to identify, document and evaluate key risks within a client's organisation. (S27/ITS4)	the client through a variety of media in a professional setting through performing socio-technical process improvements in a range of environments. (S25/ITS2) Critically evaluates how they participate in walk-throughs for IT, to identify, document and evaluate key risks within a client's organisation. (S27/ITS4)
Technical Solutions S29	Evaluates how they effect change within an organisation through evaluation of a new system, process or initiative. (S29/ITS6)	
Data Analyst (ADF apprentices only)		
Underlying Principles K53 K55 K57	Describes the barriers that exist to effective data analysis between analysts and their stakeholders and how to avoid or resolve these. (K53/DAK1) Explains data formats, structures, architectures and data delivery methods including "unstructured" data. (K55/DAK3)	

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	Explains approaches to data processing and storage, database systems, data warehousing and online analytical processing, data-driven decision making and the good use of evidence and analytics in making choices and decisions. (K57/DAK5)	
Technical Solutions K59	Describes how Data Analytics can be applied to improve an organisation's processes, operations and outputs. (K59/DAK7)	Evaluates how data analytics can be applied to improve an organisation's processes, operations and outputs. (K59/DAK7)
Legal, Ethics and Landscape K60	Describes how data and analysis may exhibit biases and prejudice. Describes how ethics and compliance affect Data Analytics work, and the impact of international regulations. (K60/DAK8)	
Innovation and Response S48 S49 S51	Describes how they define Data Requirements and perform Data Collection, Data Processing and Data Cleansing. (S48/DAS1) Describes how they apply different types of Data Analysis, as appropriate, to drive improvements for specific business problems. (S49/DAS2) Describes how they have encountered	Evaluates how they define Data Requirements and perform Data Collection, Data Processing and Data Cleansing. (S48/DAS1) Evaluates how they apply different types of Data Analysis, as appropriate, to drive improvements for specific business problems. (S49/DAS2) Evaluates how they identify barriers to

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	barriers to effective analysis both by analysts and their stakeholders within data analysis projects. (S51/DAS4)	effective analysis encountered both by analysts and their stakeholders within data analysis projects. (S51/DAS4)

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